

Lab 1.1: Draft an ICP Profile

*Module 1 · Lesson 1: Building Ideal
Customer Profiles (ICPs)*

Introduction

You work in business development for ProClean Commercial Services, a company that provides professional office cleaning and janitorial services to other businesses. ProClean cannot pursue every business with equal effort. To focus outreach on the accounts most likely to fit, buy, and stay, the team needs a clear Ideal Customer Profile. In this lab, you will build that profile by translating a real business context into specific, targetable criteria.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lab, you will be able to:

- Describe a basic ICP for ProClean.
- Identify the firmographic and demographic criteria that define a high-fit customer.
- Distinguish fit signals that qualify an account from disqualifiers that rule one out.
- Write a precise one-sentence ICP summary that guides outreach rather than describing services.



Scenario

Company Name: ProClean Commercial Services

Industry: Commercial office cleaning and janitorial services

ProClean provides professional office cleaning and janitorial services to other businesses, including daily cleaning, deep cleaning, carpet cleaning, window washing, and supply restocking. Its target market consists of small to medium businesses with roughly 20 to 200 employees that operate out of dedicated office spaces.

Your Role

You are a business development team member at ProClean. Your task is to draft a basic ICP for a hypothetical customer in an industry of your choice, such as professional services, healthcare offices, technology, or finance, using the ICP Template Worksheet provided.

Tools/Downloadable Resources

Reading: Prospecting Playbook: Defining Your ICP

Downloadable Resource: ICP Template Worksheet

Downloadable Resource: Lab 1.1 Exemplar Solution

Activity Steps

Exercise 1: Draft an ICP Profile

Step 1: Choose a Target Industry

Select an industry that fits ProClean's office-based service model.

- Consider whether businesses in this industry typically operate out of dedicated office spaces.

- Confirm the industry falls within ProClean's target size range of 20 to 200 employees.

- Note any structural traits that make this industry a strong fit.

Step 2: Fill in the Firmographic Fields

Using the ICP Template Worksheet, complete the firmographic section for your chosen industry.

- Include industry, company size, and location or geography.

- Note structural traits that signal fit, such as multiple floors or sites, in-office staff, or lease type.

- Be specific enough to guide outreach. For example, "40 to 150 employee professional-services firms leasing a single downtown floor" is targetable; "businesses with offices" is not.

Step 3: Fill in the Demographic Fields

Complete the demographic section for your likely buyer.

- Identify the role or title that owns this decision.

- Describe their priorities and what success looks like for them.

- Frame the buyer in ProClean's language of fit, not a list of services.

Step 4: Note Fit Signals and Disqualifiers

Identify one or two fit signals and one disqualifier.

- Fit signals should tell you an account is high-fit.

- A disqualifier should tell you clearly that an account is not a match.

- If a field does not apply to your industry, note why rather than leaving it blank. Naming what you are excluding is part of building a sharp ICP.

Step 5: Write a One-Sentence ICP Summary

Draft a single sentence that captures who ProClean's ideal customer is in your chosen industry.

- The summary should be specific enough to exclude the wrong accounts.

- It should describe the customer, not the service.

- It should be precise enough to guide outreach decisions independently.

Success Criteria

A strong submission will:

- Describe the customer in ProClean's language of fit, not a list of services.
- Use specific criteria rather than broad descriptors. For example, "40 to 150 employee professional-services firms leasing a single downtown floor" is targetable; "Businesses with offices" is not.
- Name excluded criteria where a field does not apply to the chosen industry rather than leaving it blank.
- Include fit signals and at least one clear disqualifier.

Self-Assessment Checklist

By the end of this lab, you should have:

- A partially completed ICP worksheet with the key firmographic and demographic fields filled in for your chosen industry.

- At least one fit signal and one disqualifier clearly identified.

- A one-sentence ICP summary that captures who ProClean's ideal customer is in the chosen industry.

Note: You do not need to complete every optional field. Focus on the criteria that most clearly define a high-fit ProClean customer.

Summary

Congratulations! You have completed this lab by drafting a basic Ideal Customer Profile for ProClean Commercial Services in an industry of your choice. In this lab, you practiced translating a real business context into specific, targetable firmographic and demographic criteria that define a high-fit customer. You also learned how to separate fit signals from disqualifiers and how to write a precise one-sentence ICP summary that guides outreach rather than describing services.
